in the NSCN(K). One group under Khaplang is entrenched mainly in Myanmar and the breakaway faction under self-styled General Khole Konyak and Kitovi Zhimomi, predominantly comprising of Indian Nagas, is Nagaland-based. The latter group has expelled its founder-chairman, Khaplang, and the leadership has passed into the hands of Khole and Kitovi. This statement has been repudiated by the Khaplang faction. These groups have imposed on the people a 'parallel government' and levy taxes, fines, extortion demands and carry out other illegal acts. However, there is a public outcry against this mindless violence and taxation burden. The people have unequivocally rejected the idea of an armed struggle for independence and other demands of the NSCN groups. They want a peaceful resolution of the problem. A historic covenant for peace had been signed on 18 September 2010 by the leaders of various Naga groups, including NSCN-IM General Secretary Muivah, NSCN-K General Secretary Kitovi Zhimomi and their Federal Government of Nagaland/Nagaland Nationalist Council counterparts. A ceasefire monitoring group handles all complaints of violation of the ceasefire agreement. At the same time, there has been an ongoing dialogue between the Government of India and the leaders of the NSCN-IM to find a peaceful solution to the Naga problem. The Government of India has committed that it is prepared to discuss any solution within the Constitution of India and I am hopeful that permanent peace will return to Nagaland. Recently I met with General Thinouselie, who is in his late seventies, in Dimapur, and he categorically told me that the anti-Shillong accord groups have misled the people all these years. The people are looking forward to the end of strife, and ushering in of an era of peace and prosperity.

The Naga insurrection was followed by Mizo and Manipuri rebel movements in the 1960s. The Mizo National Front (MNF), which launched a vicious armed rebellion on 1 March 1966, had its origin from the Mizo Famine Front, an organization that was created to alleviate the sufferings of the Mizo people as an aftermath of a widespread famine in 1959. The apathetic attitude of the administration and lack of governance provided the ballast to the rebel movement. After two decades of violence and strife in the